

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3



♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, East plays the ♠ 9, South the ♠ 5. You assume East has signaled you to continue ♠ s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick East plays the ♠ 3 and South the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both East and South are now void of ♠ s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, East won't bother ruffing, South **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠ . East will ruff and South will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of North's ♠ J. As you can see, South would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 10 6 4
 ♦ K 7 2
 ♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥ 4			

[showcards S:ST]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, East plays the ♥ J, won by South with ♥ A.

South plays the ♠ J, you follow with ♠ 5, dummy ♠ 3 and East plays the ♠ 2. South continues with the ♠ 10

Play the ♠ 6.

East's ♠ 2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠ s, obviously 3. Since South also must have 3, you must take your ♠ A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

South may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out South's ♥ K. You will win 2 ♥ s, 2 ♦ s and the ♠ A, down 1

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ A 8 7 5 2
♦ 7 5 2
♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ A Q 6

♣ Q 10 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 3 2

♥ -

♦ 10 9 8 4 3

♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5

♥ K Q 9 4

♦ K J

♣ 8 7 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

[showcards W:H5 N:HT]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the

dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 4
♦ J 8 6 4 2
♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 10 7 5



♠ 8

♥ A 10 9 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6 2

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A K

♣ Q 8

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, East takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

West	North	East	South
		2♥	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥4			